

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting

December 19th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FjtSXNe9sHY
Publication Date	2024-12-20T02:55:41Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held prior to the regular meeting.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:24 Presiding officer called to order the December 19th meeting of the Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Bishop, Rebella, Wagley, Low, and Dale.
 - **Absent:** Miller.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title, but leading the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Board member raised extensive factual concerns and requested to table the November 21st meeting memoranda, but the motion to table failed.

- A subsequent motion to approve the prior meeting memoranda as presented was made and seconded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with a roll call vote (Bishop: Yes, Dale: No, Perella: Yes, Wagley: Yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:02:52 Claims from the Controller

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig (Controller).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The Controller presented claims, highlighting an energy bill payment for the old YMCA (500 South Mulberry) which is being forwarded to the new property owner for potential reimbursement (under an agreement effective September 1st). Board members questioned an invoice from E&B Paving for nearly \$21,000 regarding paving on Wilshire (between Brier and Meadow), noting that City crews performed the labor and questioning whether E&B was involved or if the work quality met standards. A question was also raised regarding legal fees paid to Barnes & Thornburg for Indiana stamping work.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to approve the claims *with the exception* of the E&B Paving Wilshire invoice (\$20,828.10) pending further investigation. Approved via roll call vote (Bishop: Yes, Dale: Yes, Perella: Yes, Wagley: No).

00:30:13 Property Purchase Application: 1605 West 9th Street

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (Director) / Summer Johnson (Applicant).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Summer Johnson submitted an application to purchase 1605 West 9th Street (adjacent to her residence at 1601) for \$500 to use as a children's play area, basketball goal setup, and garden space.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Summer Johnson spoke regarding her intent to use the lot to keep children active and expand gardening.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to sell 1605 West 9th Street to Summer Johnson for \$500. Approved via roll call vote (Bishop: Yes, Dale: Yes, Rebella: Yes, Wagley: Yes).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:03:00 (Note: General updates and questions occurred continuously during board reports, but formal citizen forum occurred later).
- 04:00:00 (Approximate timestamp sequence for public comment):

- **00:43:58 Ed Canat (F.C. Tucker):** Shared that Dr. Horton dropped off a bag of goodies for the office staff to thank the commission for their role in putting a local housing project together.
- **00:44:42 Rick Yenser (Newsmen and Author):** Addressed spending transparency regarding Columbus Avenue (\$2 million), Ready Grant funding breakdowns, economic development return on investment, and raised concerns regarding property management and supplier labor sourcing for regional housing and tax credit developments.
- **00:46:22 Carly Aker-King:** Introduced herself as the new Executive Director for Madjax Muncie, expressed appreciation for the commission's continued support, and noted looking forward to aligning organizational goals with the MRC.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Director's Report (00:08:55):** Jeff presented TIF fund updates, noting strong balances and a projected Consolidated TIF fund ending balance of roughly \$3.6 to \$3.7 million. Updates were provided on Storer States housing (four homes under construction), the skate park construction, downtown gateway points, the \$30+ million in private commitments tied to the pending Ready Grant, a hotel feasibility study indicating a strong case for an 80-room nationally branded downtown hotel, and ongoing housing stock/commuter labor discussions.
 - **Land Bank Update (00:31:54):** Nate Howard reported on 40 properties awarded in April (two deeds received, two redeemed, 36 court-awarded and moving to quiet title action), upcoming proposals for county-owned vacant properties in the Old West End, Whitely, and Industry neighborhoods, urban planning partnerships with Ball State University, and a detailed tax sale analysis report compiled for public transparency.
 - **Downtown Development Report:** Skipped due to an apparent scheduling misunderstanding.
 - **Next Meeting:** Scheduled for January 16th.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made and seconded. Meeting adjourned **00:47:33**.